

THE WINTERBORNE

The Winterborne is a monster supplement for 5e that presents arctic barbarian tribes as a structured, escalating threat rather than a single interchangeable “northern raider” stat block. Instead of relying on one generic fur-clad warrior, this book provides a full ladder of winter roles—from snow scouts and axe-initiates to berserkers, spirit whisperers, warcallers, and frost-marked chieftains—each designed to fill a distinct function during play.

The intent of this product is terrain dominance and tribal escalation. Each Winterborne role supports a specific style of engagement: snowfield ambush, pursuit across frozen tundra, shock assault, spiritual manipulation, omen-reading, or clan coordination. Alliances between tribes are temporary, leadership is earned through strength and sign, and military structure is intentionally absent. These stat blocks can represent isolated hunting bands, coastal raiders, glacier nomads, spirit-bound covens, or united winter war-hosts. The Winterborne are tools of endurance, ferocity, and primal winter will—who they raid, what spirits guide them, and how united they stand is left entirely in the GM’s hands.

IMAGES

Images are included for both male and female winterborne for each entry.

THE WINTERBORNE LADDER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Winterborne Child	0	Hardened youth raised in snow camps and ice-carved shelters. Already acclimated to cold and scarcity.
Winterborne Commoner	0	Hunters, fishers, hide-workers, and bone-carvers who sustain the tribe. Capable of defending camp when threatened.
Winterborne Snow Scout	1/8	Light trackers and sentries who move silently across snowfields. The tribe’s eyes and early warning.
Winterborne Axeling	1/4	Initiated warriors bearing hand axes and round shields. Fight in close-knit kin-groups.
Winterborne Ice Stalker	1/2	Stealth ambushers who use drifts and whiteout conditions to isolate prey before striking.
Winterborne Fur Raider	1	Core raiding force clad in layered hides and furs. Fast and brutal in close combat.
Winterborne Frost Berserker	2	Rage-driven shock warriors resistant to cold and indifferent to pain. They lead the charge.
Winterborne Spirit Whisperer	3	Tribal witch who communes with ancestral and winter spirits. Shapes battle through curses and blessings.
Winterborne Blizzard Hunter	4	Elite predator-warriors nearly invisible in snowfall or storm. Masters of frozen terrain.
Winterborne Ice Witch	5	Coven leader and ritualist who binds spirits, shapes frost, and protects the tribe with winter rites.
Winterborne Warcaller	6	Charismatic raid-leader who unites allied clans temporarily. Inspires feral charges rather than drilled formations.
Winterborne Totem Bearer	7	Spirit-bound champion embodying wolf, bear, or mammoth aspects of primal winter.
Winterborne Storm Seer	8	High witch who reads omens in the aurora and calls blizzards upon enemies.
Winterborne Frost Chieftain	8	Dominant tribal leader chosen by strength and omen. Commands loyalty through reputation, not bureaucracy.

WINTERBORNE FROST BERSERKER

Medium humanoid (human), any alignment

Armor Class 17 (unarmored defense)

Hit Points 95 (10d8 + 50)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)	8 (−1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws Con +7

Skills Athletics +6, Intimidation +3, Survival +3

Damage Resistances cold

Senses passive Perception 11

Languages Common

Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Snow Camouflage. This human has advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks made in snow or icy terrain.

Relentless Assault. If this human hits a creature with two melee attacks on its turn, the target must succeed on a DC 14 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack (2). This human makes two weapon attacks.

Greataxe. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (1d12 + 4) slashing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS:

Feral Rage (Recharge 5–6). As a bonus action, this human enters a rage for 1 minute. While raging, it has resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage, advantage on Strength checks and saving throws, and its melee attacks deal an extra 4 (1d8) damage. The rage ends early if this human is incapacitated.

- Activate Feral Rage early.
- Focus on strongest visible opponent.
- Rarely retreats; fights until incapacitated.



WINTERBORNE ICE WITCH

Medium humanoid (human), any alignment

Armor Class 14 (furs, bone charms)

Hit Points 135 (18d8 + 54)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Wis +8, Con +6

Skills Insight +8, Religion +5, Medicine +8

Damage Resistances cold

Senses passive Perception 15

Languages Common

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +3

Snow Camouflage. This human has advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks made in snow or icy terrain.

Aura of Winter. Creatures of this human's choice that start their turn within 10 feet of it take 5 (1d10) cold damage.

Innate Spellcasting. This human's spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 16, +8 to hit with spell attacks). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

- **At will:** [ray of frost](#), [thaumaturgy](#)
- **3/day each:** [hold person](#), [spirit guardians](#) (cold damage only)
- **1/day each:** [cone of cold](#)

ACTIONS:

Ritual Hand Axe. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) slashing damage plus 4 (1d8) cold damage.

Ritual Rebuke (Recharge 5–6). This human targets one creature it can see within 60 feet. The target must succeed on a DC 17 Constitution saving throw or take 27 (6d8) cold damage and have its speed reduced to 0 until the end of its next turn.

- Begin with area control or Spirit Guardians.
- Maintain Aura of Winter proximity pressure.
- Target clustered enemies with cold bursts.



WINTERBORNE WARCALLER

Medium humanoid (human), any alignment

Armor Class 21 (unarmored defense, shield)

Hit Points 168 (16d8 + 96)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	16 (+3)	22 (+6)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Str +8, Con +9

Skills Athletics +8, Intimidation +6, Survival +5

Damage Resistances cold

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Common

Challenge 6 (2,300 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +3

Snow Camouflage. This human has advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks made in snow or icy terrain.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack (3). This human makes three weapon attacks.

Greataxe. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (1d12 + 5) slashing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS:

Battle Roar. Allied Winterborne within 10 feet of this human have advantage on their first melee attack each round.

Call to the Charge (Recharge 5–6). Allied Winterborne within 30 feet of this human can use their reaction to move up to half their speed and make one weapon attack.

- Use Call to the Charge early to initiate.
- Stay central to maximize Battle Roar.
- Focus on directing allies more than personal damage.



COMPATIBLE CONTENT

Winterborne can be found at the [Winter Ice Wall](#) or any of the arctic [wilderness maps](#).

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